APTOHIRE

Market Sizing: TAM, SAM & SOM

India-first opportunity framing and transparent bottom-up scenarios

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Research note: distinguish sourced facts from estimates and strategic hypotheses. Market sizing below is a transparent planning model, not an independently verified market-revenue forecast.

1. Executive view

AptoHire's initial wedge should be institution-led: help universities and placement teams make student capability more visible, then give employers a consent-based route to discover evidence-backed candidates. This strategy is more defensible than launching as a generic job board, but it requires proof that institutions will adopt and maintain the workflow.

2. Evidence base

Indicator	Public source finding	Implication / limitation
Higher education enrolment	AISHE 2022–23 reports approximately 4.46 crore enrolled students; 2023–24 report has been published by AISHE, but this document does not extract its detailed tables.	Use as a scale indicator, not as the number of employable candidates or paying users.
Institution base	AISHE 2021–22 listed 1,168 universities/university-level institutions, 45,473 colleges and 12,002 standalone institutions; later reports are available.	Large, fragmented potential institution base; counts need refresh from latest AISHE tables before investor use.
Graduate employability	Mercer's Graduate Skill Index 2025 reports 42.6% overall employability among graduates who apply for jobs, based on 1M+ students across 2,700+ campuses.	Supports the relevance of skills-readiness discussion; not proof that AptoHire solves the issue.
Youth employment transition	Azim Premji University's State of Working India 2026 describes the education-to-employment transition as a continuing challenge and notes graduate employment growth has not matched graduate growth.	Macro context; do not use this report as a direct estimate of AptoHire's addressable market.

3. TAM, SAM and SOM — bottom-up planning model

A reliable revenue TAM requires a defined buyer, price, and current institution segmentation. Those inputs are not yet validated. Therefore, use a transparent account-based model rather than borrowing a broad global HR-tech market number.

Layer	Planning definition	Illustrative calculation	Interpretation
TAM	All Indian higher-education institutions that could plausibly purchase student skill verification / placement analytics.	Planning range: 5,000–15,000 potentially relevant institutions × ■3–10 lakh annual contract value = ■150–1,500 crore/year.	Scenario range only; not a sourced count or market forecast. Validate buyer fit and willingness to pay.
SAM	Institutions initially reachable with a digital-first product, English-first workflows, active placement operations and suitable student cohorts.	Example: 500–2,000 institutions × ■3–8 lakh/year = ■15–160 crore/year.	Initial serviceable segment hypothesis; needs qualification by institution type, budget and decision process.
SOM	First 3-year obtainable accounts under a founder-led sales motion.	Example: 10–50 paying institutions × ■3–8 lakh/year = ■0.3–4 crore ARR.	Execution scenario, not a forecast. Depends on sales cycle, pilot conversion and onboarding capacity.

Do not present the scenario calculations as independently verified market size. These are explicit assumptions intended to be replaced by customer discovery, real pricing tests, and current AISHE segmentation.

4. Core formulas

• TAM (annual revenue) = eligible total accounts × validated average annual contract value (ACV).

• SAM = TAM accounts that match the initial product, geography, deployment and buyer constraints × ACV.

• SOM = accounts realistically won over the chosen period × expected realized ACV; show both account count and ARR.

• Optional employer-side revenue must be modeled separately only after the primary buyer and pricing model are decided; avoid double-counting the same workflow.

5. Recommended segmentation

Segment	Why it may fit	Validation question
Private universities with active TPOs	Potentially faster procurement than large public systems; clear placement pressure.	Who owns budget: TPO, dean, IT, registrar or central administration?
University groups / multi-campus institutions	One deal may cover multiple campuses and cohort analytics.	Can procurement approve one platform across campuses?
Tier-2/Tier-3 colleges with placement teams	Potential need for structured evidence and employer access.	Is there budget, staff capacity and employer demand to sustain profiles?
Employers hiring early-career talent	Potential secondary buyer for evidence-backed shortlists.	Will recruiters pay for signal quality, or expect it bundled into sourcing?
Students	Essential users and beneficiaries.	Avoid charging students before strong value and fairness are proven.

6. Commercial hypotheses to test

• Institutions will pilot a measurable skill-evidence workflow if setup effort is low and outcomes support placement readiness.

• Placement teams value cohort-level skill gaps and student evidence more than another standalone job board.

• Employers will review anonymized, evidence-linked candidate cards if match reasons are interpretable and access friction is low.

• Students will complete projects and grant selective access when the scorecard is useful, transparent and appealable.

• Pricing should initially be tested as annual institution license or paid pilot; per-student, employer access and hybrid pricing remain options, not decisions.

7. Sources

Ministry of Education / AISHE, All India Survey on Higher Education reports: https://aishe.gov.in/document-category/aishe-final-reports/ . Government press release on AISHE 2021–22: https://www.pib.gov.in/Pressreleaseshare.aspx?PRID=1999713 . Mercer, India’s Graduate Skill Index 2025: https://www.mercer.com/insights/talent-and-transformation/talent-assessment/indias-graduate-skill-index-2025/ . Azim Premji University, State of Working India 2026: https://azimpremjiuniversity.edu.in/publications/2026/report/swi-2026 .